

ABC COMPANY

Employee Leave Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This Leave Policy establishes the framework governing all categories of employee leave at ABC Company (“the Company”). It defines eligibility, accrual, application procedures, and approval workflows to ensure fair, consistent, and transparent administration of leave benefits across the organization.

This policy applies to all full-time, part-time, and fixed-term contract employees of ABC Company across all office locations, unless a specific employment contract or local statutory regulation provides otherwise. Interns and employees engaged through third-party staffing agencies are governed by separate agreements and are not covered under this policy.

2. Leave Year and General Principles

The Company's leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December. All leave balances are reset or carried forward (as applicable) at the start of each leave year. Leave is accrued on a monthly basis unless stated otherwise for a specific leave category.

- Leave requests must be submitted through the ABC Company HR Portal at least the minimum notice period specified for each leave type, except in cases of medical or family emergencies.
- All leave is subject to approval by the employee's Reporting Manager and, where applicable, the Human Resources department.
- Employees are responsible for ensuring adequate handover of critical work before proceeding on planned leave.
- Leave cannot be availed during an active notice period without prior written approval from HR, except for statutory leave types.
- Misrepresentation of facts to avail any leave category will be treated as a violation of the Company's Code of Conduct and may result in disciplinary action.

3. Categories of Leave – Summary

The table below summarizes the principal leave categories available to eligible employees. Detailed provisions for each category follow in Section 4.

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Eligibility	Carry Forward
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days/year	All employees, from date of joining	Not permitted
Earned / Privilege Leave (EL)	18 days/year	Confirmed employees only	Up to 30 days
Sick Leave (SL)	12 days/year	All employees, from date of joining	Not permitted
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	Female employees, as per statute	Not applicable
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Male employees, on childbirth/adoption	Not applicable
Bereavement Leave	5 working days	All employees	Not applicable

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Eligibility	Carry Forward
Marriage Leave	5 working days	Confirmed employees, once during tenure	Not applicable
Compensatory Off	As accrued	Employees required to work on holidays	Weekends used within 60 days
Leave Without Pay (LWP)	As approved	All employees, subject to approval	Not applicable

4. Detailed Leave Provisions

4.1 Casual Leave (CL)

Casual Leave is granted for short, unforeseen personal matters such as domestic emergencies or brief personal errands. Employees accrue 1 day of Casual Leave per completed month of service, up to a maximum of 12 days per year. Casual Leave cannot be combined with Earned Leave for a period exceeding 3 consecutive days without prior HR approval, and unused Casual Leave lapses at the end of the leave year with no carry-forward or encashment.

4.2 Earned / Privilege Leave (EL)

Earned Leave is intended for planned vacations and personal time off and is available to employees upon confirmation of employment following the probationary period. Employees accrue 1.5 days per completed month, totaling 18 days annually. Requests for Earned Leave exceeding 5 consecutive days must be submitted at least 15 days in advance. A maximum of 30 days of unused Earned Leave may be carried forward to the following leave year; balances beyond this cap will lapse unless the employee opts for encashment under the Company's encashment policy, where applicable.

4.3 Sick Leave (SL)

Sick Leave may be availed in the event of illness or injury preventing the employee from performing their duties. Employees are entitled to 12 days of Sick Leave per year, credited at 1 day per month. For absences exceeding 2 consecutive working days, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner must be submitted to HR upon return to work. Sick Leave does not carry forward and is not encashable.

4.4 Maternity Leave

Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid Maternity Leave for the first two children, in accordance with applicable statutory requirements. For a third or subsequent child, entitlement is 12 weeks. Up to 8 weeks of this leave may be availed prior to the expected date of delivery, with the remainder following childbirth. Employees must notify HR and their Reporting Manager at least 8 weeks before the anticipated start of leave, accompanied by a medical certificate confirming the expected delivery date.

4.5 Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to 10 working days of paid Paternity Leave, to be availed within 3 months of the birth or legal adoption of a child. This leave may be taken in a single block or split into a maximum of two instances, subject to manager approval.

4.6 Bereavement Leave

In the unfortunate event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling, or parent-in-law), employees are entitled to 5 working days of paid Bereavement Leave. This leave may be availed immediately upon notifying the Reporting Manager, without the standard advance notice requirement.

4.7 Marriage Leave

Confirmed employees are entitled to 5 working days of paid leave on the occasion of their own marriage. This benefit may be availed only once during the employee's tenure with the Company and requires at least 30 days' advance notice along with supporting documentation.

4.8 Compensatory Off

Employees required to work on a Company-designated holiday or weekend at the explicit instruction of their manager are eligible for a Compensatory Off equal to the number of days worked. Compensatory Off must be availed within 60 days of accrual, failing which it will lapse; it is not encashable.

4.9 Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Leave Without Pay may be granted at the sole discretion of management when an employee has exhausted all applicable paid leave balances and requires additional time off. LWP exceeding 15 consecutive days requires approval from the Department Head and HR, and extended periods of LWP may affect the employee's benefits, increment eligibility, and service continuity calculations as outlined in the Compensation and Benefits Policy.

5. Leave Application Procedure

All leave requests, except emergency Sick Leave and Bereavement Leave, must be submitted in advance through the following process:

- 1 Log in to the ABC Company HR Portal and navigate to the "Apply for Leave" section.
- 2 Select the appropriate leave type, specify the start and end dates, and provide a brief reason.
- 3 Attach supporting documentation where required (e.g., medical certificate, invitation card).
- 4 Submit the request; it will be routed automatically to the Reporting Manager for approval.
- 5 Upon approval or rejection, the employee will receive an email and portal notification.
- 6 In case of emergency leave, notify the Reporting Manager via phone or email on the first day of absence and formalize the request on the portal within 2 working days of return.

6. Approval Authority and Escalation

Leave requests of up to 5 consecutive working days may be approved directly by the Reporting Manager. Requests exceeding 5 consecutive working days require additional approval from the Department Head. In the Reporting Manager's absence, requests are automatically escalated to the next-level manager to avoid processing delays. HR reserves the right to review and audit leave records periodically to ensure policy compliance.

7. Public Holidays

ABC Company observes a list of paid public holidays each year, published by HR in January and made available on the HR Portal. Locations may observe up to 3 additional regional holidays based on local statutory requirements. If a public holiday falls on a weekend, no compensatory holiday will be granted unless mandated by local law.

8. Unauthorized Absence

Any absence from work without prior approval or valid notification, other than a genuine emergency communicated within 24 hours, will be classified as an Unauthorized Absence and treated as Leave Without Pay for the corresponding days. Repeated instances of unauthorized absence may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment, in accordance with the Company's Disciplinary Policy.

9. Leave Encashment

Eligible employees may encash a portion of their accumulated Earned Leave balance once per leave year, subject to a minimum retained balance of 10 days and a maximum encashment limit of 15 days. Encashment requests must be submitted through the HR Portal during the designated encashment window announced annually by HR. Upon separation from the Company, employees will be paid out for any unused, encashable Earned Leave balance as part of their full and final settlement.

10. Policy Review and Amendments

This policy is reviewed periodically by the Human Resources department and may be amended to reflect changes in applicable labor law, business requirements, or organizational structure. Employees will be notified of any material changes via official Company communication channels at least 30 days prior to the effective date of such changes, where feasible.

This document is a fictional, sample HR policy created for practice, training, or demonstration purposes (e.g., RAG / document-retrieval projects) and does not represent an actual company policy.